TOPIC OR MAIN IDEA?

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

A topic is what a text is about, in a word or two: "dogs". A main idea is what the text says about the topic, in a whole sentence: "Dogs need daily exercise." Sort the twelve cards, then match each topic to its main idea.

Dogs need daily exercise to stay healthy.

Dogs

The rainforest

Rainforests are home to more than half the world's animal species.

Volcanoes

Volcanoes form where melted rock pushes through the Earth's crust.

Brushing your teeth twice a day prevents cavities.

Teeth

The moon

The moon has no light of its own; it reflects the sun.

Bicycles

Bicycles are a cheap and healthy way to travel short distances.

Topics a word or phrase	**Main ideas** a complete sentence

MATCH THE TOPIC TO ITS MAIN IDEA

1. **Penguins** .....
2. **Breakfast** .....
3. **Thunderstorms** .....
4. **Maps** .....

Thunderstorms form when warm, wet air rises quickly.

Penguins are birds that swim instead of fly.

Maps use symbols and a key to show real places on paper.

Eating breakfast helps children concentrate at school.

TOPIC OR MAIN IDEA? ANSWER KEY

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

A topic is what a text is about, in a word or two: "dogs". A main idea is what the text says about the topic, in a whole sentence: "Dogs need daily exercise." Sort the twelve cards, then match each topic to its main idea.

Dogs need daily exercise to stay healthy. M

Dogs T

The rainforest T

Rainforests are home to more than half the world's animal species. M

Volcanoes T

Volcanoes form where melted rock pushes through the Earth's crust. M

Brushing your teeth twice a day prevents cavities. M

Teeth T

The moon T

The moon has no light of its own; it reflects the sun. M

Bicycles T

Bicycles are a cheap and healthy way to travel short distances. M

Topics a word or phrase

Dogs
The rainforest
Volcanoes
Teeth
The moon
Bicycles

Main ideas a complete sentence

Dogs need daily exercise to stay healthy.
Rainforests are home to more than half the world's animal species.
Volcanoes form where melted rock pushes through the Earth's crust.
Brushing your teeth twice a day prevents cavities.
The moon has no light of its own; it reflects the sun.
Bicycles are a cheap and healthy way to travel short distances.

MATCH THE TOPIC TO ITS MAIN IDEA

1. **Penguins** .....
2. **Breakfast** .....
3. **Thunderstorms** .....
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Thunderstorms form when warm, wet air rises quickly.

Penguins are birds that swim instead of fly.

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Eating breakfast helps children concentrate at school.

1 Penguins → birds that swim; 2 Breakfast → helps children concentrate; 3 Thunderstorms → warm wet air rises; 4 Maps → symbols and a key.

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